

**GENERAL PROBLEM:** On Intrinsic Work Motivation

**SPECIFIC PROBLEM:** To compare the intrinsic orientation of the Work Motivation among working professionals from Educational sector and IT sector

**BASIC CONCEPT:** Motivation generally refers to the force which may be responsible to generate, guide and maintain the desired behaviour. It is the driving force that leads to goal directed behavior. Robbins, Judge and Sanghi (2007) defined it as "the processes that account for an individual's intensity, direction, and persistence of effort towards attaining a goal." According to Butkus & Green (1999), motivation is derived from the word "motivate", means to move, push or influence to proceed for fulfilling a want. According to Stephen P. Robbins (2001), "Motivation is the willingness to exert high levels of effort toward organizational goals, conditioned by the effort's ability to satisfy some individual need."

Work motivation is an enigmatic topic in work and organisational science (Kanfer, Chen, & Pritchard, 2008). Pinder (1998) defined work motivation as "a set of energetic forces that originates both within as well as beyond an individual's being, to initiate work-related behaviour, and to determine its form, direction, intensity and duration". Thus, this motivation refers to the internal drive and external influence that inspire employees to take action and perform effectively toward achieving organizational goals.

Orientation of motivation concerns the underlying attitudes and goals that give rise to action, i.e., it concerns the why of actions. The amount of motivation does not necessarily vary, but the nature and focus of the motivation being evidenced certainly does (Deci & Ryan, 2000). In work and other context, motivation is often described as being intrinsic or extrinsic in nature. Intrinsic motivation is defined as the doing of an activity for its inherent satisfactions rather than for some separable consequence (Deci & Ryan, 2000).

Motivation that comes from within an individual, driven by personal satisfaction, interest, or enjoyment in the task itself. Extrinsic motivation refers to doing an activity to attain some separable outcome, such as earning a reward or avoiding punishment." (Deci & Ryan, 1985). Extrinsic motivation occurs when external factors such as rewards, praise, incentive or recognition drive behaviour rather than the inherent enjoyment of the activity.

**Factors Affecting Motivation:** Motivation is influenced by both internal and external factors that determine a person's willingness to act toward achieving a goal.

### **Internal (Personal) Factors**

- **Needs and Desires:** Basic needs like food, safety, and belonging motivate behavior.
- **Goals:** Clear and achievable goals guide effort and persistence.
- **Interest and Attitude:** Positive attitude and interest in a task increase motivation.
- **Personality:** Ambition, optimism, and self-confidence enhance motivation.
- **Values and Beliefs:** What a person values (success, respect, purpose) shapes their motivation.
- **Expectancy and Self-efficacy:** Belief that effort will lead to success encourages action.

### **External (Environmental) Factors**

- **Rewards and Recognition:** External rewards like praise or money motivate performance.
- **Social Influence:** Support and approval from others can boost motivation.
- **Opportunities:** Chances for growth or achievement increase effort.

## Factors Affecting Work Motivation

**1. Individual Factors:** These are personal characteristics and internal elements that shape how employees perceive and respond to their work.

- **Job Satisfaction:** When employees find their work meaningful and feel appreciated for their efforts, they are more motivated to perform well. Satisfaction with pay, co-workers, and management also contributes to motivation.
- **Career Goals and Aspirations:** Clear professional goals and the desire for advancement push employees to work harder and stay committed.
- **Competence and Self-confidence:** Employees who believe in their own abilities tend to take initiative and show persistence, even when challenges arise.
- **Work-life Balance:** When organizations respect employees' personal time and reduce burnout, motivation and commitment remain strong.
- **Personality and Attitude:** Optimistic, responsible, and achievement-oriented individuals are naturally more motivated to meet work standards.

**2. Organizational Factors:** These are external conditions created by the organization that can encourage or discourage motivation.

- **Leadership Style:** Leaders who support, guide, and involve employees in decision-making foster higher motivation compared to autocratic leadership.
- **Work Environment:** A safe, comfortable, and positive workplace atmosphere helps employees feel valued and productive.
- **Rewards and Incentives:** Fair salaries, bonuses, promotions, and verbal recognition serve as strong motivators. Both monetary and non-monetary rewards play key roles.
- **Job Design and Enrichment:** Jobs that are challenging, meaningful, and allow creativity or autonomy keep employees engaged and motivated.
- **Career Development Opportunities:** Training, mentoring, and chances for advancement motivate employees to improve their skills and stay loyal to the organization.
- **Organizational Culture:** A culture that promotes trust, teamwork, fairness, and open communication nurtures long-term motivation and commitment

## Theories of Work Motivation

- **Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs (1943):** Abraham Maslow proposed that human motivation develops through a hierarchy of five needs, physiological, safety, social, esteem, and self-actualization. He suggested that people are motivated to satisfy lower-level needs first, and once these are fulfilled, higher-order needs become dominant. In the workplace, this means that once employees' basic and security needs are met, they seek social belonging, recognition, and ultimately opportunities for personal growth.
- **Herzberg's Two-Factor Theory (1959):** Frederick Herzberg distinguished between two sets of factors that influence motivation: motivators and hygiene factors. Motivators such as achievement and responsibility create job satisfaction and drive higher motivation, while hygiene factors like salary and working conditions only prevent dissatisfaction. This theory highlights that improving extrinsic conditions alone does not motivate employees unless the work itself is meaningful.
- **McClelland's Theory of Needs (1961):** David McClelland emphasized three learned needs that drive behavior at work, the need for achievement, power, and affiliation. Individuals differ in the strength of these needs, and each leads to different motivational patterns. For example, high achievers seek challenging goals, those high in power seek influence and leadership, and those high in affiliation value social relationships and teamwork.
- **Vroom's Expectancy Theory (1964):** Victor Vroom viewed motivation as a rational process where individuals evaluate how likely their effort will lead to desired outcomes. According to this theory, motivation is determined by three components: expectancy (belief that effort leads to performance), instrumentality (belief that performance will lead to rewards), and valence (the value of those rewards). Employees are motivated when they believe their effort will produce valuable results.
- **Adams' Equity Theory (1963):** J. Stacy Adams proposed that motivation is strongly influenced by perceptions of fairness. Employees compare their input–output ratio (effort versus rewards) with those of others. If they perceive inequality, they experience tension and may reduce effort or seek to restore balance. The theory underscores the importance of maintaining equity in pay, recognition, and workload.
- **Locke's Goal-Setting Theory (1968):** Edwin Locke argued that clear, specific, and challenging goals enhance motivation and performance more than vague or easy goals. Goals serve as a guide for behavior, focusing attention and effort in a particular direction. Feedback and commitment to goals further strengthen motivation, as individuals see progress toward meaningful outcomes.
- **Job Characteristics Model (1976):** Hackman and Oldham proposed that motivation depends on how jobs are structured. They identified five core job dimensions: skill variety, task identity, task significance, autonomy, and feedback, which together create a sense of meaningfulness, responsibility, and knowledge of results. When these dimensions are present, employees experience high intrinsic motivation and satisfaction.

## Special Theories of Intrinsic and Extrinsic Motivation

- **Self-Determination Theory (Deci & Ryan, 1985):** Self-Determination Theory (SDT) focuses on the quality of motivation rather than its quantity. It posits that individuals have three basic psychological needs, autonomy, competence, and relatedness that foster intrinsic motivation. When these needs are fulfilled, people engage in work willingly and experience deep satisfaction. However, when external controls undermine autonomy, intrinsic motivation tends to decrease.
- **Cognitive Evaluation Theory (Deci, 1975):** A sub-theory within SDT, Cognitive Evaluation Theory suggests that external rewards such as money or praise can sometimes diminish intrinsic motivation. This happens when rewards are perceived as controlling rather than supportive. However, if rewards are used to acknowledge competence and reinforce autonomy, they can enhance intrinsic motivation.
- **Flow Theory (Csikszentmihalyi, 1990):** Mihaly Csikszentmihalyi's Flow Theory describes a state of total absorption in work where individuals lose track of time and experience deep enjoyment. Flow occurs when a task's challenge matches an individual's skill level, creating a balance between difficulty and ability. This theory emphasizes the intrinsic satisfaction derived from engaging in meaningful and challenging activities.
- **Self-Efficacy Theory (Bandura, 1977):** Albert Bandura's concept of self-efficacy highlights the role of belief in one's own ability to perform specific tasks. When individuals feel confident about their capabilities, they set higher goals, exert more effort, and persist longer in the face of obstacles. High self-efficacy thus strengthens both intrinsic interest and overall motivation.
- **Intrinsic–Extrinsic Motivation Continuum (Ryan & Deci, 2000):** Ryan and Deci expanded the idea of motivation into a continuum ranging from a motivation (lack of drive) to extrinsic motivation (driven by external rewards) to intrinsic motivation (driven by personal satisfaction). The theory emphasizes that motivation becomes more self-determined and powerful as it moves toward the intrinsic end of the continuum.

**Description of Intrinsic Work Motivation:** Intrinsic work motivation represents a psychological drive to engage in tasks for inherent satisfaction, interest, or personal challenge rather than for external rewards or avoidance of punishment (Ryan & Deci, 2000). Such motivation is closely tied to self-determination theory, emphasizing autonomy, competence, and relatedness as motivating factors (Ryan & Deci, 2000; Malone & Lepper, 1987). Employees high in intrinsic motivation derive fulfillment from the work itself, embracing opportunities to solve problems, take on challenges, and develop skills (Ryan & Deci, 2000). This form of motivation is linked to increased job satisfaction, engagement, creativity, and persistence across work environments (Gurland & Lam, 2012; BetterUp Blog, 2025).

**Intrinsic Work Motivation in Different Work Sectors:** Intrinsic motivation is shaped by sector-specific factors. In the educational sector, professionals, particularly teachers and academic staffs, often report high intrinsic motivation due to a strong alignment between personal values (such as nurturing growth, curiosity, and societal impact) and daily work tasks (Layek et al., 2024). The potential for autonomy, mastery, and meaningful work in education supports sustained intrinsic engagement, especially when educators are challenged intellectually and recognized for their contributions (Ryan & Deci, 2000; BetterUp Blog, 2025).

In the IT sector, intrinsic motivation is fostered by opportunities for solving complex problems, continual learning, and competence development. Employees in IT may be driven by curiosity, enjoyment of technological challenges, and innovation, especially in roles that offer autonomy and the chance to master new skills (NoFluffJobs, 2024). While extrinsic rewards (e.g., bonuses, promotions) are significant in IT, balancing these with internal motivators is crucial for long-term engagement and well-being (Ryan & Deci, 2000; BetterUp Blog, 2025). Sector comparisons reveal that while both groups can exhibit high intrinsic work motivation, the source and expression may differ: educators emphasize societal impact and personal fulfilment, whereas IT professionals value problem-solving and skill mastery (Layek et al., 2024).

**Review of Literature:** Intrinsic motivation refers to engaging in work for inherent satisfaction rather than external rewards (Deci & Ryan, 1985). According to Self-Determination Theory (SDT), fulfillment of autonomy, competence, and relatedness fosters intrinsic motivation (Ryan & Deci, 2000). In organizational settings, employees who perceive greater autonomy and opportunities for growth show higher creativity and job satisfaction.

In the IT sector, intrinsic motivation is crucial because tasks often involve innovation, problem solving, and self-learning. Studies indicate that Indian IT professionals value learning opportunities and meaningful work over monetary benefits. For instance, Kumar and Thomas (2021) found that intrinsic motivation significantly predicted work engagement among Indian IT employees, emphasizing the role of autonomy and skill development. Similarly, case studies of Infosys and TCS highlight how continuous learning programs and recognition systems enhance employees' intrinsic motivation (NASSCOM, 2020).

In contrast, in the educational sector, intrinsic motivation largely stems from the sense of purpose, teaching passion, and contribution to students' development. Bhatnagar and Srivastava (2012) reported that private-college teachers in India were motivated by achievement and meaningfulness of work rather than external rewards. However, administrative workload and limited academic autonomy often reduce motivation levels. A study by Kumar and Sinha (2020) observed that faculty members with higher perceived autonomy and institutional support exhibited stronger intrinsic motivation and job satisfaction.

Comparatively, while both sectors depend on knowledge and creativity, IT employees derive intrinsic motivation through skill mastery and innovation, whereas educators derive it from purpose and social

contribution. Yet, organizational support, autonomy, and recognition remain common predictors of intrinsic motivation across both sectors.

Overall, literature suggests that Indian private organizations should nurture autonomy, continuous learning, and meaningful engagement to sustain employees' intrinsic motivation and long-term commitment (Ryan & Deci, 2000; NASSCOM, 2020).

Work motivation also has been a central concern in organizational psychology, with research expanding from classical Western theories to cross-cultural and international contexts. Early frameworks such as Vroom's (1964) expectancy theory and Locke and Latham's (1990) goal-setting theory provided foundational insights into how individuals' expectations, goals, and perceived outcomes influence effort and performance. However, as organizations globalized, scholars began questioning the universality of these models, prompting comparative studies across cultures. Self-Determination Theory (SDT), proposed by Deci and Ryan (1985), introduced a more nuanced understanding of intrinsic and extrinsic motivation through the fulfillment of psychological needs for autonomy, competence, and relatedness. Gagné and Deci (2005) extended SDT to workplace contexts internationally, revealing that while need satisfaction predicts motivation across countries, the meaning and expression of autonomy vary by culture. This insight aligns with Hofstede's (1980, 2001) cultural dimensions theory, which demonstrated that societies differ in values such as individualism–collectivism and power distance, differences that shape how employees perceive incentives and workplace autonomy. Similarly, the GLOBE study (House et al., 2004) offered large-scale evidence that cultural norms influence leadership, commitment, and motivation patterns across 62 societies, underscoring that effective motivational strategies must align with cultural contexts. Empirical studies comparing Western and non-Western samples often find that intrinsic motivation is universally beneficial but that extrinsic motivators, such as rewards or recognition, are more effective in collectivist societies where social harmony and group goals are emphasized (Gagné & Deci, 2005; Hofstede, 2001). Meta-analytic evidence further supports partial universality of motivational processes while highlighting contextual moderators like economic development, labor systems, and cultural values (Steers, Mowday, & Shapiro, 2004). Methodologically, cross-cultural motivation research emphasizes the importance of measurement equivalence to ensure that constructs like job satisfaction and motivation are interpreted similarly across settings. Overall, international studies converge on the idea that while fundamental motivational needs are shared across humanity, the mechanisms that fulfill these needs, and the management practices that sustain motivation, are shaped by cultural and institutional differences, requiring both global awareness and local adaptation in organizational practice.

Recent international work in motivation research has deepened understanding of both universal and culture-specific drivers of work behaviour. For instance, Gagné et al. (2015) validated the Multidimensional Work Motivation Scale (MWMS) across nine countries and in seven languages, showing that the structure of autonomous vs. controlled motivation holds across diverse linguistic/cultural settings, and that associations

from leadership and job design to motivation, and motivation to outcomes (commitment, performance, well-being, turnover intention) are largely consistent. Building on that, a study among Chinese employees (Yang et al., 2021) found that autonomous motivation positively predicts both work performance and innovative work behaviour, but that the benefits of autonomous motivation are blunted under high financial stress; controlled motivation had a weaker or context-dependent effects.

## **METHODOLOGY:**

**Sample-** Data was gathered from a sample, comprising 4 IT sector and 4 Education sector employees. A standardised Intrinsic Work Motivation Questionnaire developed by Dr. A.P. Singh and Dr. L.K. Mishra (2009) were used to collect the primary data from the respondents.

### **Materials Required-**

(For Offline Mode)

1. Intrinsic Work Motivation Questionnaire Consumable Booklet {developed by Dr. A.P. Singh and Dr. L.K. Mishra.(2009)}
2. Demographic Datasheet
3. Consent Form
4. Response Sheet
5. Manual
6. Stationaries
7. Table-Chair and Quiet Room

(For Online Mode)

1. Google Form (Digital Intrinsic Work Motivation Questionnaire)
2. Scoring Sheet / Excel Sheet
3. Device ( Phone or Laptop)
4. Internet Connection

**Description of the Test:** The Intrinsic Work Motivation Questionnaire, developed by Dr. Ashok Pratap Singh and Dr. Lalit Kumar Mishra, is a specialized tool designed to measure the intrinsic orientation of work motivation in employees within an organization. It is a twelve item, 5-point likert rating scale covering four key dimensions of intrinsic motivation: Challenge, Interest, Competence, and Autonomy. The scale is administered to adults, and the items are rated using response alternatives ranging from Strongly Agree to Strongly Disagree. Scoring is done by summing the scores, with a special procedure for 10 true-keyed items and 2 false-keyed items. The Intrinsic Work Motivation Questionnaire is suitable for both practical measurement and research purposes.

**Instructions:** "Welcome, and thank you for taking the time to participate in this assessment. Before we begin, please take a moment to sit comfortably and relax. In this questionnaire, you will find statements related to situations which generate an internal force within you, which pulls you towards your work. Please read all the

statements carefully and place a tick on one of the five responses for each one. Your answer may range from Strongly Agree to Strongly Disagree. Please respond to each statement honestly by putting a tick on the alternative that you think is correct for you. There are no right or wrong answers. Try to complete the scale within 5 minutes for effective data collection, though there is no time limit. Your responses are strictly confidential and will be used only for academic, research, or professional assessment purposes. If you have any questions at any point, feel free to ask."

**Procedure:** The respondents were provided with the Consumable Booklet to fill in their demographic details and then tick one of the five Likert-scale responses for each of the 12 items which best describes them and were assured of confidentiality of the test. They were requested to complete the scale within 5 minutes. Subsequently, scoring was performed by calculating the arithmetic summation of the scores for all 12 items. Because the scale consisted of 10 true-keyed and 2 false-keyed items (items 9 and 10), two different scoring patterns were adopted: true-keyed items were scored in a descending order (e.g., Strongly Agree = 5), while false-keyed items were scored in an ascending order (e.g., Strongly Agree = 1). The final intrinsic work motivation score was then used for interpretation by referencing the norms provided in the manual. The total score was categorized into three levels of intrinsic motivation: Low (12-42), Moderate (43-49), and High (50-60). Additionally, dimension-wise scores for Challenge, Interest, Competence, and Autonomy were also interpreted against their respective norms. The conclusion provided a summary of the respondent's overall intrinsic work motivation level, as well as their standing on each of the four dimensions, indicating the relative internal force driving their work behavior.

**Intrinsic Work Motivation Questionnaire:** This questionnaire was developed and standardized by Mishra & Singh (2009) to measure the intrinsic orientation of the work motivation in the organization. This is five Point Likert-type rating scales having a total of 12 items. The 12 items which were related to the following areas–

**Table-1** represents areas of intrinsic work along with the item numbers

| Serial No. | Area of Intrinsic Work Motivation | Item Numbers |
|------------|-----------------------------------|--------------|
| 1          | Challenge                         | 1, 5, 8, 9   |
| 2          | Interest                          | 3, 6, 12     |
| 3          | Competence                        | 4, 7, 10     |
| 4          | Autonomy                          | 2, 11        |



**Reliability and Validity:** To assess the intrinsic orientation of work motivation, this questionnaire was developed following an extensive review of relevant literature. Initially, 18 items were constructed. Item analysis was carried out using the corrected item–total correlation method, with correlation values ranging from  $-.02$  to  $.45$ . Three items showing low correlation were excluded from further analysis. For the remaining 15 items, the corrected item–total correlation values ranged from  $.27$  to  $.49$ . The reliability of this version, computed using Cronbach’s alpha coefficient, was  $.76$ .

The factor structure of the scale was examined using principal component analysis with varimax rotation ( $N = 206$ ). Factor loadings of the 15 items exceeded the criterion of  $.366$ , resulting in a five-component solution that explained 58 % of the total variance. Because three items exhibited cross-loadings, they were omitted. The final version comprised 12 items. The reliability of this final questionnaire, again computed by Cronbach’s alpha, was  $.74$ , indicating satisfactory internal consistency.

**Scoring Procedure:** Intrinsic Work Motivation Questionnaire comprises dimensions namely challenge, interest, competence and autonomy. Out of twelve items constituting the scale, 10 items were true keyed and remaining 2 items were false keyed. The possible scores of each item ranged from one to five. High scores represent high intrinsic motivation towards work.

**Table-2 represents the true or positive framed and false or negative framed items**

|                   |    |                                |
|-------------------|----|--------------------------------|
| True keyed items  | 10 | 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 11, 12 |
| False keyed items | 2  | 9, 10                          |

Since the scale consists of both true keyed and false keyed items, therefore, two different patterns of scoring have to be adopted. The scores ranged in ascending order for the false keyed items and in descending order for true keyed items. The following table provides guide line for the scoring:

**Table-3 represents the scores of the both true and false keyed items along with the responses**

| Response Alternatives | Scores for True Keyed Items | Scores for False Keyed Items |
|-----------------------|-----------------------------|------------------------------|
| Strongly Agree        | 5                           | 1                            |
| Agree                 | 4                           | 2                            |
| Undecided             | 3                           | 3                            |

|                   |   |   |
|-------------------|---|---|
| Disagree          | 2 | 4 |
| Strongly Disagree | 1 | 5 |

The intrinsic work motivation scores will be determined by the arithmetic summation of the scores endorsed to all the items of the particular dimension from a total of 12 items. Items will be rated on a 5-point scale, with higher numbers reflecting higher standing on this construct.

**Norms for the Intrinsic Work Motivation Questionnaire:** Norms have been prepared for Intrinsic Work Motivation Questionnaire on a representative sample of employees working in the organizations.

**Table 4 (Total Score):** The table represents the total norm score along with the descriptions in which level/category the sample will fall.

| Sr. No. | Score | Description                   |
|---------|-------|-------------------------------|
| 1.      | 12–42 | Low Intrinsic Motivation      |
| 2.      | 43–49 | Moderate Intrinsic Motivation |
| 3.      | 50–60 | High Intrinsic Motivation     |

**Table 5** represents the Dimension-wise Norms of the first division (**Challenge**)

| Sr. No. | Score | Description        |
|---------|-------|--------------------|
| 1.      | 04–13 | Low Challenge      |
| 2.      | 14–17 | Moderate Challenge |
| 3.      | 18–20 | High Challenge     |

**Table 6** represents the Dimension-wise Norms of the second division (**Interest**)

| Sr. No. | Score | Description       |
|---------|-------|-------------------|
| 1.      | 06–13 | Low Interest      |
| 2.      | 14–15 | Moderate Interest |
| 3.      | 16–18 | High Interest     |

**Table 7** represents the Dimension-wise Norms of the third division (**Competence**)

| Sr. No. | Score | Description    |
|---------|-------|----------------|
| 1.      | 03–09 | Low Competence |

|    |       |                     |
|----|-------|---------------------|
| 2. | 10–12 | Moderate Competence |
| 3. | 13–15 | High Competence     |

**Table 8** represents the Dimension-wise Norms of the fourth division (**Autonomy**)

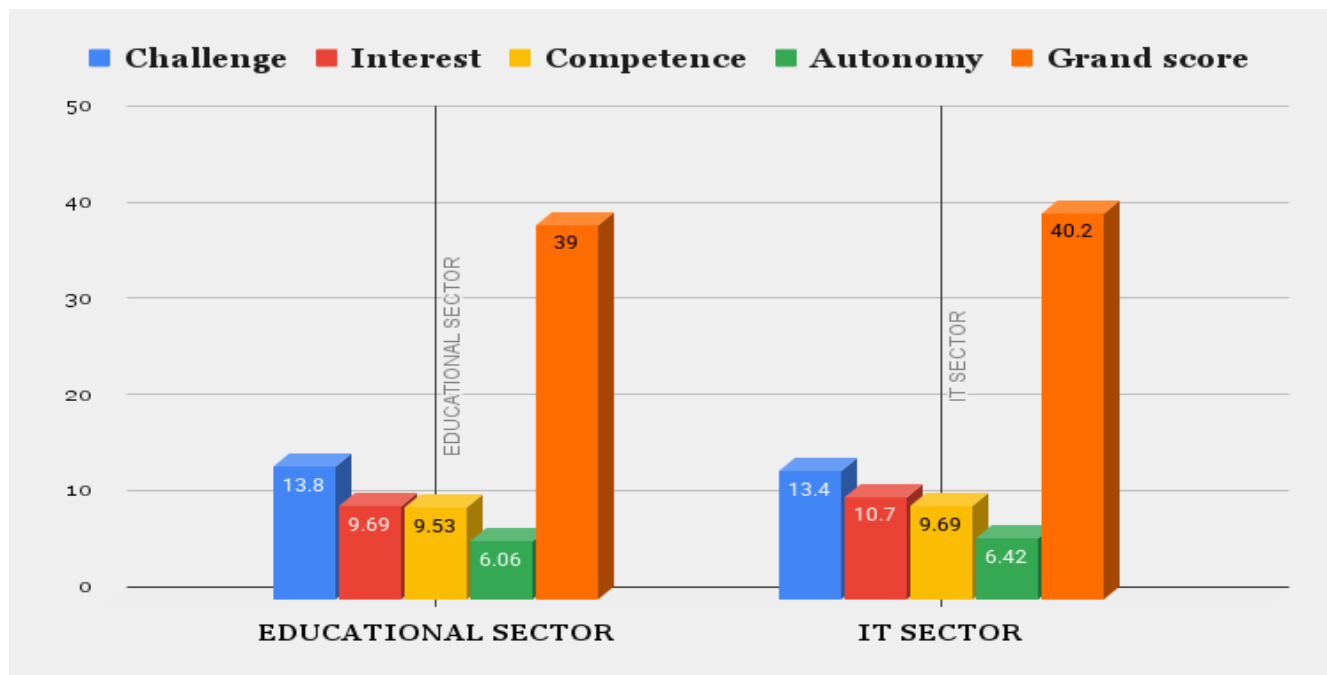
| Sr. No. | Score | Description       |
|---------|-------|-------------------|
| 1.      | 02–06 | Low Autonomy      |
| 2.      | 07–08 | Moderate Autonomy |
| 3.      | 09–10 | High Autonomy     |

**RESULTS: Table 9: Represents descriptive statistics of the Grand Score, Challenge, Interest, Competency & Autonomy of the Educational Sector and IT Sector.**

| Descriptive        |                    |           |          |            |          |             |
|--------------------|--------------------|-----------|----------|------------|----------|-------------|
|                    | A                  | Challenge | Interest | Competence | Autonomy | Grand Score |
| N                  | Educational Sector | 36        | 36       | 36         | 36       | 36          |
|                    | IT Sector          | 36        | 36       | 36         | 36       | 36          |
| Mean               | Educational Sector | 13.8      | 9.69     | 9.53       | 6.06     | 39.0        |
|                    | IT Sector          | 13.4      | 10.7     | 9.69       | 6.42     | 40.2        |
| Median             | Educational Sector | 14.0      | 10.0     | 9.50       | 6.00     | 41.0        |
|                    | IT Sector          | 14.0      | 11.0     | 10.0       | 6.00     | 42.0        |
| Standard deviation | Educational Sector | 3.52      | 4.29     | 2.86       | 2.33     | 11.2        |
|                    | IT Sector          | 3.58      | 3.21     | 2.41       | 2.14     | 9.52        |
| Minimum            | Educational Sector | 6         | 3        | 3          | 2        | 16          |

|                |                           |           |           |           |           |           |
|----------------|---------------------------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|
|                | <b>IT Sector</b>          | <b>6</b>  | <b>4</b>  | <b>5</b>  | <b>3</b>  | <b>23</b> |
| <b>Maximum</b> | <b>Educational Sector</b> | <b>20</b> | <b>15</b> | <b>15</b> | <b>10</b> | <b>55</b> |
|                | <b>IT Sector</b>          | <b>21</b> | <b>15</b> | <b>14</b> | <b>10</b> | <b>57</b> |

**Figure 1: Graphical representation of the difference in mean scores of Challenge, Interest, Competency and Autonomy among Education and IT Sector.**



**Table 10: Represents the results of Independent Sample T-Test of all the Domains and Grand Score of Intrinsic Motivation**

| <b>Independent Samples T-Test</b> |                    |                           |             |              |                        |                      |
|-----------------------------------|--------------------|---------------------------|-------------|--------------|------------------------|----------------------|
|                                   |                    | <b>Statistic</b>          | <b>df</b>   | <b>p</b>     | <b>Mean difference</b> | <b>SE difference</b> |
| <b>Challenge</b>                  | <b>Student's t</b> | <b>0.398</b>              | <b>70.0</b> | <b>0.692</b> | <b>0.333</b>           | <b>0.837</b>         |
| <b>Interest</b>                   | <b>Student's t</b> | <b>-1.089<sup>a</sup></b> | <b>70.0</b> | <b>0.280</b> | <b>-0.972</b>          | <b>0.892</b>         |
| <b>Competence</b>                 | <b>Student's t</b> | <b>-0.267</b>             | <b>70.0</b> | <b>0.790</b> | <b>-0.167</b>          | <b>0.624</b>         |

|                    |                    |               |             |              |               |              |
|--------------------|--------------------|---------------|-------------|--------------|---------------|--------------|
| <b>Autonomy</b>    | <b>Student's t</b> | <b>-0.685</b> | <b>70.0</b> | <b>0.496</b> | <b>-0.361</b> | <b>0.528</b> |
| <b>Grand Score</b> | <b>Student's t</b> | <b>-0.476</b> | <b>70.0</b> | <b>0.635</b> | <b>-1.167</b> | <b>2.450</b> |

**Note.**  $H_a \mu_{\text{Educational Sector}} \neq \mu_{\text{IT Sector}}$

<sup>a</sup> Levene's test is significant ( $p < .05$ ), suggesting a violation of the assumption of equal variances

## INTERPRETATION

**Intrinsic motivation** refers to the internal drive to engage in activities for inherent satisfaction, curiosity, or personal fulfillment rather than for external rewards such as money, grades, or recognition (Deci & Ryan, 2000). It is fueled by one's psychological needs for autonomy, competence, and relatedness, which together nurture persistence, creativity, and genuine engagement at work (Gagné & Deci, 2005). The descriptive statistics show that intrinsic motivation is present at moderate to high levels in both sectors. The **IT sector** reported a slightly higher **Grand Score (M = 40.2)** compared to the **Educational sector (M = 39.0)**, indicating marginally stronger intrinsic work motivation among IT professionals. This aligns with findings by Gagné and Deci (2005), who stated that autonomy-supportive and innovation-oriented environments foster higher intrinsic motivation.

Employees in the Educational sector scored higher on the **Challenge** dimension (M = 13.8) than those in the IT sector (M = 13.4). This suggests that educators perceive their tasks as more intellectually stimulating and demanding. Teaching requires creativity, continuous adaptation, and managing diverse learners, factors that create meaningful challenge. This is supported by Csikszentmihalyi's (1990) concept of *flow*, which occurs when individuals engage in optimally challenging tasks. Similarly, Eisenberger and Shanock (2003) found that employees experiencing high levels of challenge demonstrate increased creativity, performance, and commitment. Thus, the higher Challenge scores in the educational sector reflect the cognitively rich and dynamic nature of teaching.

The **Interest** dimension was higher among IT professionals (M = 10.7) than educators (M = 9.69). The technological and innovative structure of IT work may explain this higher interest. Constant exposure to new tools, coding languages, and problem-solving situations stimulates curiosity and engagement. Research by Sansone and Thoman (2005) shows that interest enhances persistence and performance in tasks, while Grant (2008) found that work perceived as inherently enjoyable increases intrinsic motivation. Amabile and Pratt

(2016) also highlighted the link between varied, intellectually stimulating tasks and heightened intrinsic motivation. Thus, the higher Interest scores observed in the IT sector reflect the novelty and exploration inherent in technological work.

Both sectors exhibited similar levels of competence, with mean scores of **9.53 (Educational)** and **9.69 (IT)**. This minimal difference (0.16 points) indicates that employees in both fields feel capable, skilled, and effective in their roles. According to Deci and Ryan (2000), the need for competence is a fundamental driver of intrinsic motivation. Stajkovic and Luthans (1998) also found that high self-efficacy enhances motivation, performance, and willingness to take on challenging tasks. The comparable scores suggest that both educators and IT professionals possess strong role-related skills and self-efficacy, contributing positively to intrinsic motivation.

The IT sector recorded a higher mean in Autonomy ( $M = 6.42$ ) than the Educational sector ( $M = 6.06$ ). IT roles often provide flexible work systems, freedom in problem-solving and greater control over task execution. This finding corresponds with research by Hackman and Oldham (1980), which identified autonomy as a key psychological driver of meaningful and motivated work. Deci et al. (2017) and Gagné et al. (2015) further confirmed that autonomy enhances creativity, satisfaction, and intrinsic motivation. The lower autonomy in the Educational sector may reflect structured schedules, rigid institutional policies, and administrative constraints, which can limit teachers' perceived control.

Overall, the findings are consistent with the **Self-Determination Theory (SDT)** framework proposed by Deci and Ryan (1985, 2000), which posits that autonomy, competence, and relatedness form the foundation of intrinsic motivation. The results suggest that while both sectors support internal motivation to a significant degree, the structural and environmental factors in IT work promote slightly higher levels of autonomy and interest. Educational professionals, on the other hand, exhibit stronger perceptions of challenge and competence, reflecting deep professional commitment and purpose.

## CONCLUSION

The study found that both educational and IT professionals possess moderate to high levels of **intrinsic motivation**. IT employees showed slightly higher motivation due to greater autonomy and interest, while educators experienced more challenge and competence. These results align with **Self-Determination Theory** (Deci & Ryan, 2000), which stresses that motivation grows when autonomy, competence, and purpose are

fulfilled. Organizations can enhance motivation by promoting flexibility, creativity, and professional growth, enabling employees to find meaning and satisfaction in their work.

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